Clip Builder

Getting Started Guide — installation, first launch, profiles, and AI model setup

1. Install the App

1. Download `ClipBuilder-1.51.pkg` from the [GitHub Releases page]().
2. Double-click the downloaded `.pkg` file and follow the installer. The installer is signed and notarized by Apple, so no security warnings appear. You'll be asked for your Mac password to install.
3. When the installer finishes, a **Terminal window opens automatically** to complete setup. It installs everything Clip Builder needs and walks you through the first-time configuration:
    - `ffmpeg` (the video engine) and `yt-dlp` (video downloads) — standalone builds, no Homebrew or Xcode tools needed;
    - your choice of AI provider CLIs — Claude Code, Gemini CLI, and Codex CLI are each optional, and any of them can be added later by re-running setup (Qwen Code and Kimi Code CLI are not part of setup; install them from the app under *Settings → AI*);
    - an optional sign-in to each AI provider (you can also do this later — see section 4);
    - your first profile — brand name, content niche, social handles, and Input/Output folders.

   Anything already installed is detected and skipped, so the setup is safe to re-run.

> **Re-running setup:** if you skipped a step or the Terminal window didn't open, run it again anytime:
> `"/Library/Application Support/ClipBuilder/Clip Builder Setup.command"`

You can confirm the app sees ffmpeg under *Settings → General → Storage*, where the ffmpeg row should read Found.

2. Open the App for the First Time

Clip Builder is signed with a Developer ID certificate and notarized by Apple, so it opens normally from Launchpad or the Applications folder — no security prompts, no extra steps. The guided setup offers to launch it for you when it finishes.

3. Set Up a New Profile

A profile bundles your brand identity, folders, and scene database. The guided setup offers to create your first profile during installation; the app also keeps a *Default* profile as a fallback. To create more profiles — one per brand or project — or to edit an existing one:

1. Open **Settings** (menu bar: *Clip Builder → Settings…*, or press ⌘ ,).
2. Select the **Profile** tab.
3. Under *Profile*, type a name into **New profile name** and click **Create**. The new profile becomes the active one; you can switch profiles at any time with the *Active profile* picker.
4. Fill in the **Brand** section:
    - *Brand name* — the name used in captions and exports.
    - *Content domain* — your niche (e.g. MMA, cooking, travel). This guides the AI analysis.
    - *Instagram handle* — used when generating social captions.
5. Set the **Folders**:
    - *Input folder* — where your source videos live. The app watches this folder.
    - *Output folder* — where rendered clips are written.
6. Optionally choose **Intro / Outro** videos to be stitched onto every export.
7. Optionally customize the **Tag Schema** — one category per row with comma-separated tags. Leave it empty to use the built-in schema.
8. Click **Save Profile**.

> **Deleting a profile** removes its configuration and scene database, but never touches your source or output video files. The *Default* profile cannot be deleted.

4. Sign In to the AI Providers

Clip Builder routes its AI work (video analysis, wizard reasoning, caption generation) through locally installed AI command-line tools. During setup you choose which of the five to install — each is optional, and you can add any of them later from the app (*Settings → AI*). Each installed CLI just needs a one-time sign-in, which the guided setup offers during installation. The app reuses whatever login each tool already has, so there are no API keys to paste into Clip Builder itself.

If you chose "later" during setup (or installed a CLI yourself), here is each provider's sign-in — the `npm install` line is only needed if the CLI is missing:

4.1 Claude Code (Anthropic) — default provider

1. Run `claude` in Terminal and follow the prompts to sign in with your Claude account.
2. Available models in Clip Builder: `claude-haiku-4-5-20251001` (default), `claude-sonnet-4-6`, `claude-opus-4-8`.
3. Manual install if needed: `npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code`

4.2 Gemini CLI (Google)

1. Run `gemini` in Terminal and sign in with your Google account when prompted.
2. Available models: `gemini-2.5-flash` (default), `gemini-2.5-flash-lite`, `gemini-2.0-flash`, `gemini-2.5-pro`.
3. Manual install if needed: `npm install -g @google/gemini-cli`

4.3 Codex CLI (OpenAI)

1. Run `codex login` in Terminal and sign in with your ChatGPT account when prompted.
2. Available models: `gpt-5-mini` (default), `gpt-5-nano`, `o3-mini`, `gpt-5-codex`, `o3`, `gpt-5`.
3. Manual install if needed: `npm install -g @openai/codex`

4.4 Qwen Code (Alibaba)

1. Run `qwen` in Terminal and choose a login method (Qwen OAuth is free) when prompted.
2. Available models: `qwen3-coder-plus` (default), `qwen3-coder-flash`.
3. Manual install if needed: `npm install -g @qwen-code/qwen-code`

4.5 Kimi Code CLI (Moonshot AI)

1. Run `kimi` in Terminal and sign in with `/login` when the interface opens.
2. Available models: `kimi-code/kimi-for-coding` (default).
3. Manual install if needed: `npm install -g @moonshot-ai/kimi-code`

> **Note:** Codex, Qwen, and Kimi do not support image input in Clip Builder, so they can't be used for visual video analysis — prefer Claude or Gemini for the *Video analysis* task.

4.6 Verify and Configure in Clip Builder

1. Open **Settings** → **AI**.
2. Each provider section shows a *Status* row — it should read Installed for every CLI you set up. If it says Not found, either the CLI isn't installed or it isn't on the app's PATH; you can enter an explicit *Binary path* (e.g. `/opt/homebrew/bin/claude` — find it with `which claude`).
3. Pick a **Default model** for each provider.
4. Under **Task Routing**, choose which provider handles each task:

Task	What it does	Default
Video analysis	Watches sampled frames and describes/tags scenes	Claude Code
Wizard reasoning	Plans clip selections and edits in the Wizard	Claude Code
Caption generation	Writes social captions for exports	Claude Code

5. Click **Save**.

> **Transcription** needs no setup — it runs fully on-device using Apple's SpeechAnalyzer. You can set a language code and vocabulary hints under *Settings* → *General* → *Transcription*.

Reporting a problem

Choose **Help** → **Report a Bug…** (**⇧⌘B**). Describe what happened and how to reproduce it. The report includes diagnostic logs and app context, a screenshot you can review or remove, and crash details when available. Screenshots may include your footage. Name and email are optional; you can report anonymously.

The ladybug toolbar menu lets you take screenshots for a report and open **My Reports…** to check its status. Enable it in **Settings → General → Feedback → Show the QA button in the toolbar**; it is always visible in development builds. You can also reveal the log folder or reset your reporting identity in Feedback.

You're Ready

Point your *Input folder* at some footage, open the *Analyze* tab to scan and tag scenes, then use the *Wizard* or *Builder* to assemble and export clips.